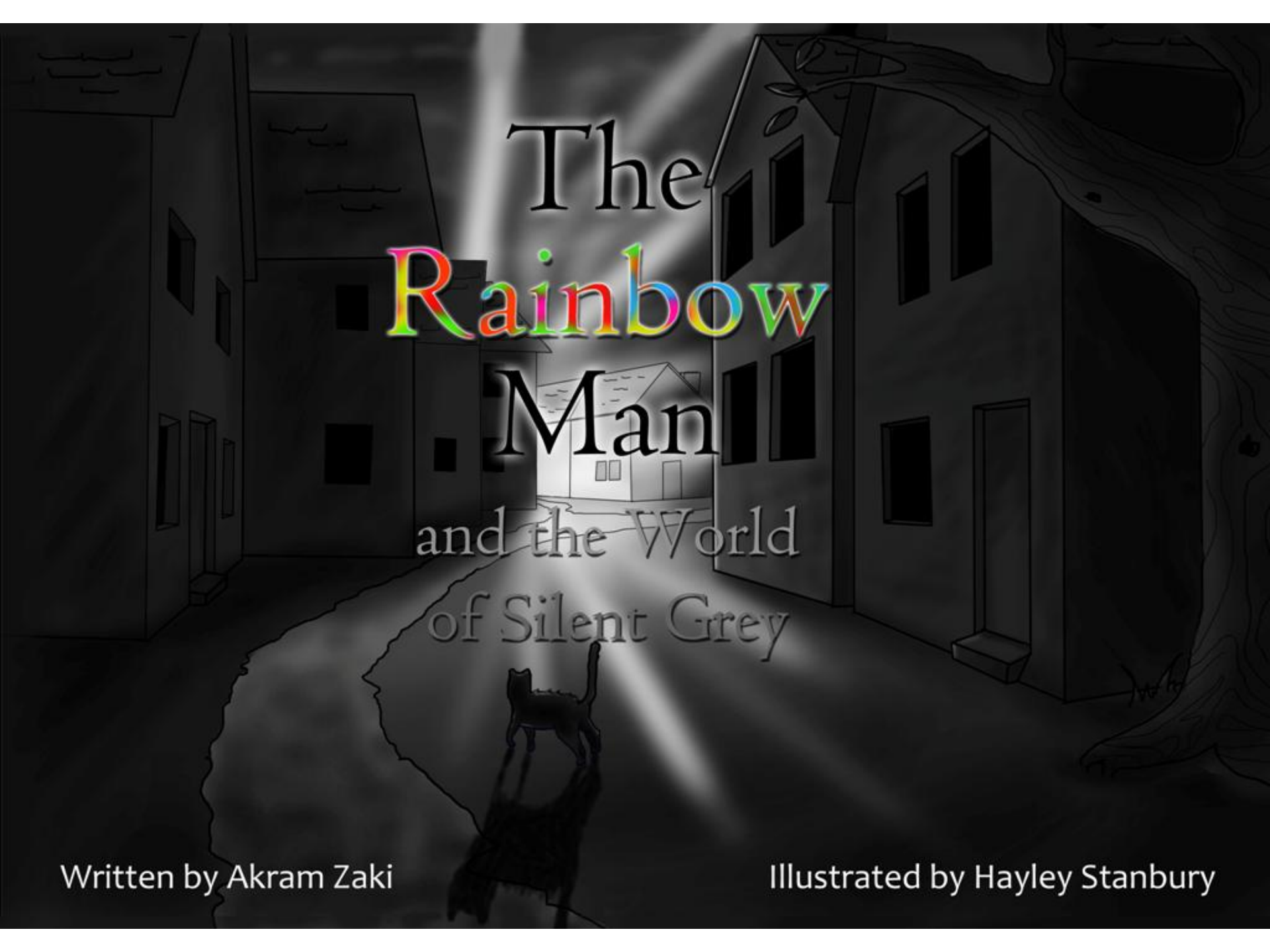




The Rainbow Man and the World of Silent Grey

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Illustrated by Hayley Stanbury

The world of silent grey was a sad, silent place,
for there was no colour and no sound.



All was grey and dull, and all was quiet.

The flowers in every field,
the sunsets over the horizon,
were grey and dull.



The birds never sang,
nor did the ocean roll and crash over the shore.



The people in the world of silent grey lived their
whole life without beauty or even music,

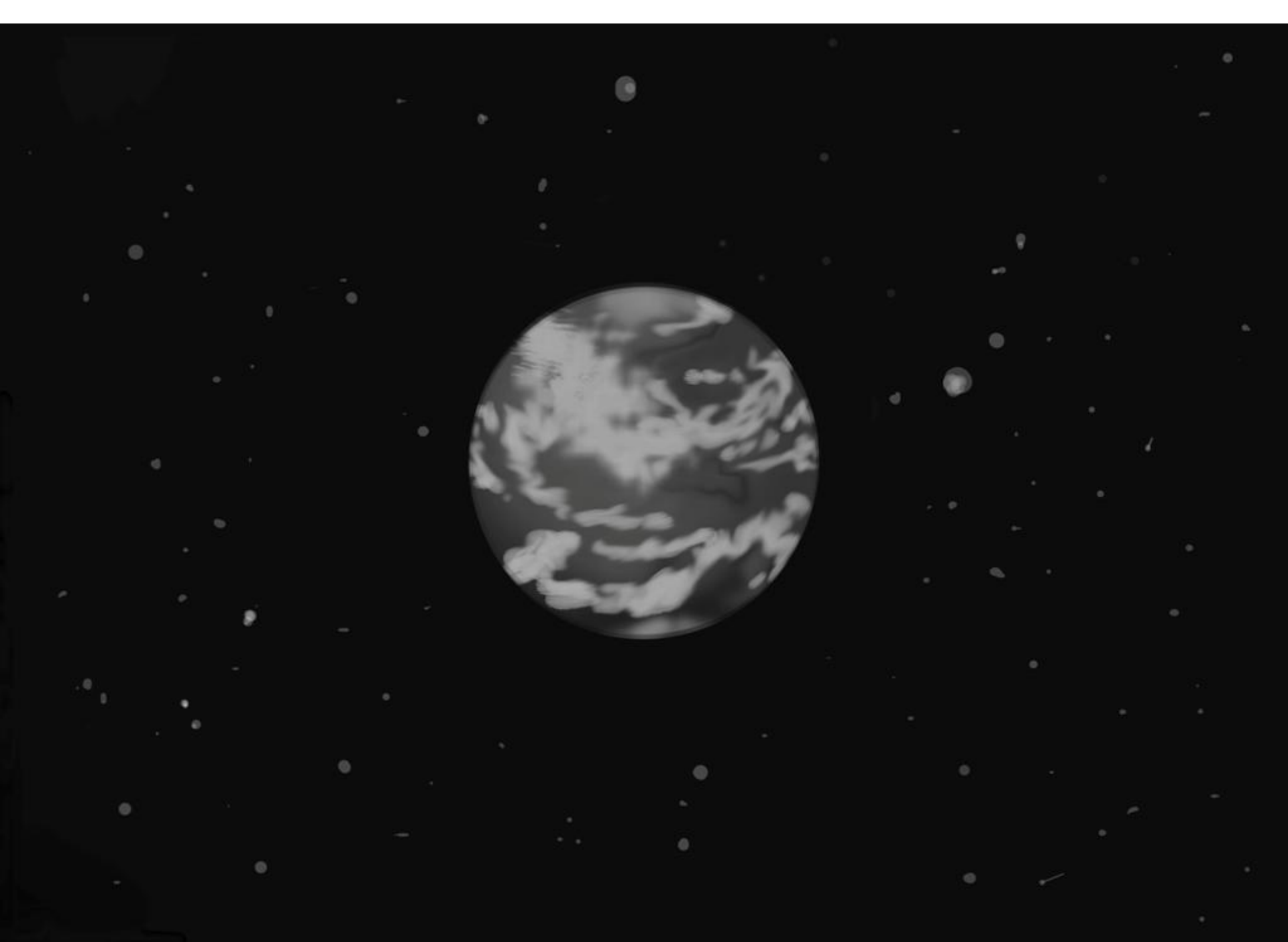
for they too, were grey and silent.



Of course,
they all knew that there was something missing.
But they did not know what,
for things had always been this way.



And so they went on,
grey and lifeless and silent,
living under a lightless sun,
in a colourless world.





But one starless night,
peircing the darkness and the silence of it all

there came the cries of a baby
as had never been heard before



Many gathered around
to see for the first time a glimmer of beauty,
the vivid and colourful light pouring from him,

and the beautiful sounds of life
such as they had never heard before.

Years passed,
and the baby grew

Those who knew of him gave him the name

The Rainbow Man.

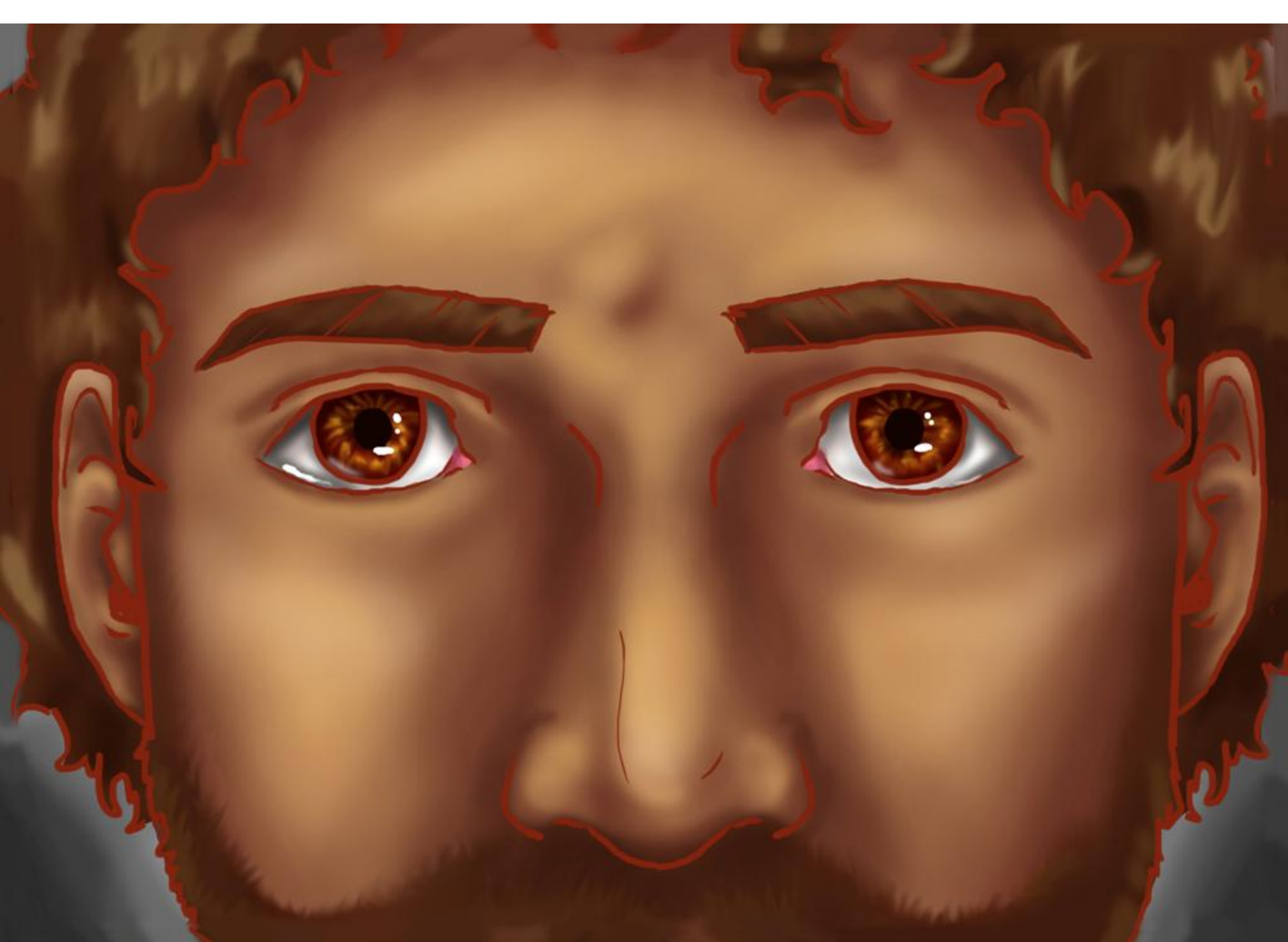




The Rainbow Man spoke beautiful words
and taught the people to sing beautiful songs,

but no one could ever sing quite like him.

Some of the people around were
jealous of the Rainbow Man,
but most of the people of the world of silent grey
loved and revered him.



The Rainbow Man would often become sad
as he saw and heard
the grey silence all around him,
and all through the world that he had grown to
love.

So the Rainbow Man began to build a machine.

A machine that would give colour and music to
the whole world.

It was hard
but The Rainbow Man persisted
until it was complete.





The Rainbow Man climbed on board the machine
and strapped himself into it.

Many people gathered around to watch as he
started the machine. It let out a hum
and parts of it started to move and whir as it
began to work.

Slowly but surely, there came out of the machine
a trickle of something strange.

It was colour!

Bit by bit
the machine began to pour fourth many colours

red and **blue**

orange **yellow**

purple and **pink**

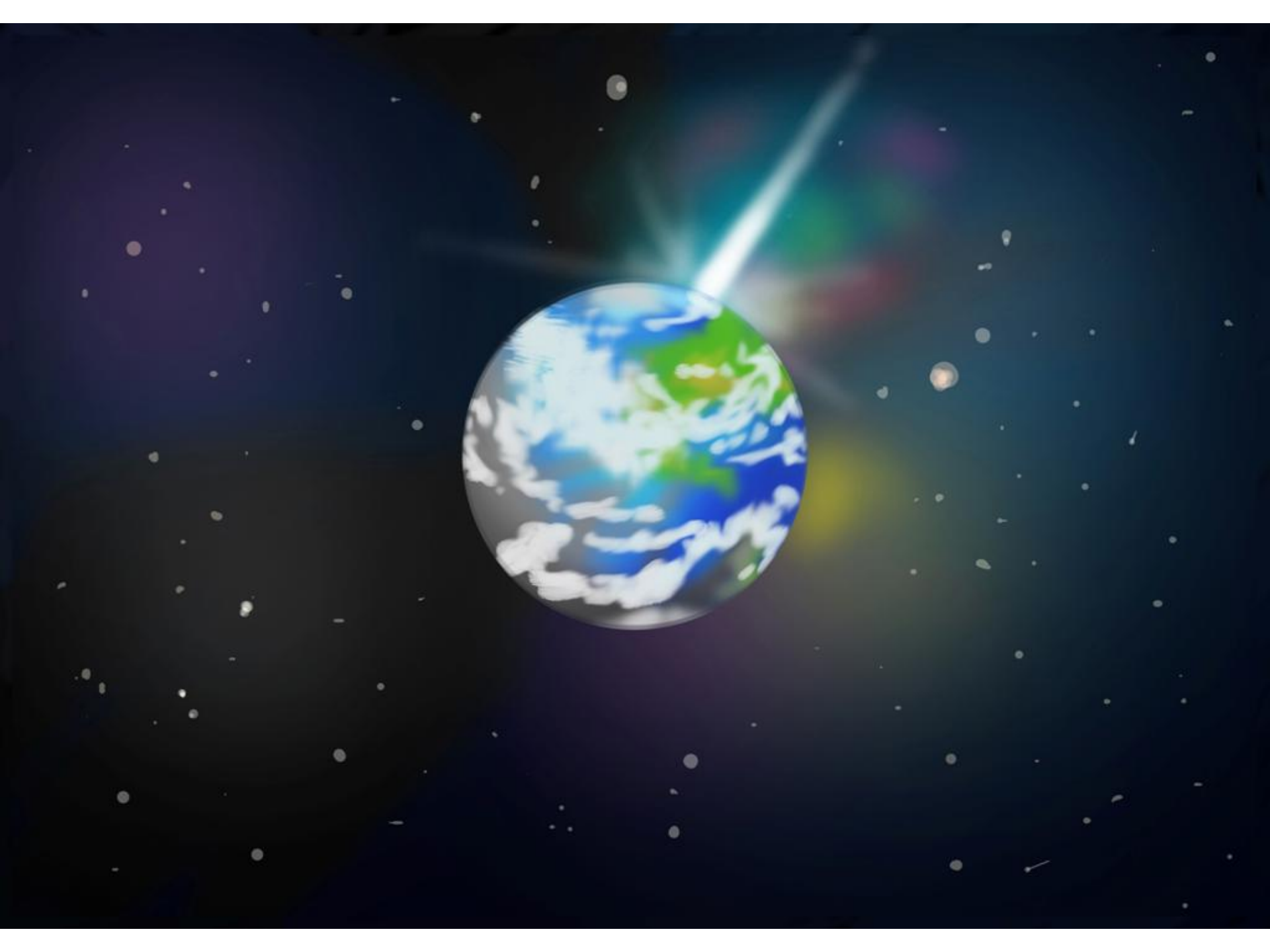
white and **brown**

and all the colours in between.



**Every colour you could think of
poured out of the Rainbow Man's machine,
and they began to cover the whole world
with colour,
and then sound
and then music.**

**The birds began to sing,
the ocean began to crash over the shore,
and there came the sounds of laughter and joy
from the people all around the world.**



**The people themselves began to notice
that they were now coloured also!
They began to laugh and sing
beautiful songs.**

The machine stopped whirring

**and everyone began to cheer
as the door of the machine opened
to reveal the Rainbow Man.**





But then everyone stopped cheering

for The Rainbow Man

was no longer a Rainbow Man.

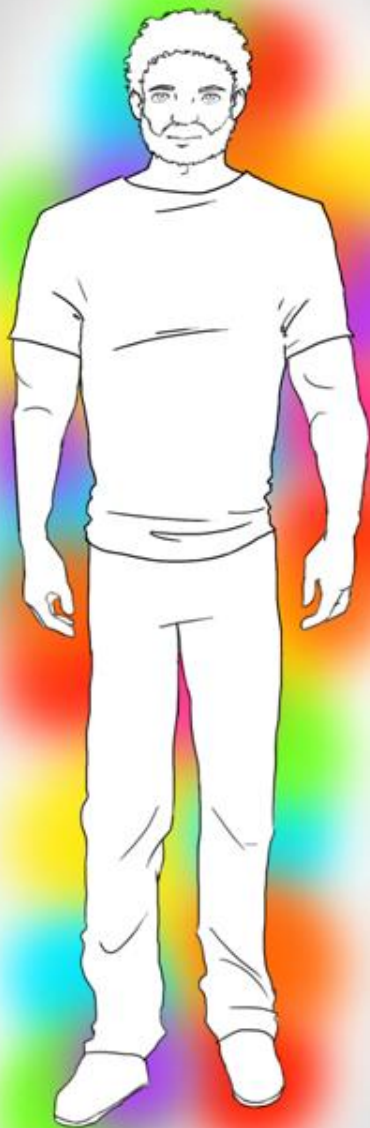
He was as grey as the people used to be.

He no longer sang songs
and spoke beautiful words.

For he was as silent as the world used to be.

**In order to give the world he loved
colour and music,
The Rainbow Man had given all of his own.**





The World of Silent Grey is a sad
and hopeless place.
But everything changes when a baby is born
who is different to everybody else.

The Rainbow man and the world of silent grey
is a story about the birth of hope, beauty and
the ultimate price of love.